

AN EBOOK ON PROMPTING · FOR DESIGNERS

The 5-Layer Prompt Framework

*How to generate stunning, studio-quality landing pages with AI – a
beginner's guide.*

STOP GETTING AVERAGE. START GETTING CINEMATIC.

Why most AI-generated designs look *cheap*.

You've seen them. The landing pages that look like they were made in 2019. Generic fonts, flat colors, lifeless layouts. The kind of page that screams "AI did this" — and not in a good way.

Here's the truth: the AI isn't the problem. The prompt is.

Most people treat AI design tools like a vending machine — put in a vague request, hope something decent comes out. "Make me a dark landing page for a tech startup." And you get exactly what you asked for. Technically correct. Completely forgettable.

The designers getting jaw-dropping results aren't more creative than you. They're more *specific* than you.

They've learned that AI works like a junior designer — incredibly fast, technically capable, but completely dependent on the brief you give it.

This ebook teaches you that brief. A 5-layer framework that transforms your prompts from vague instructions into a creative director's brief — the kind that produces pages that feel cinematic, premium, and intentional.

Think of it like directing a junior designer who's incredibly fast but needs clear direction. Give it clarity, and it gives you craft.

By the time you finish this guide, you'll know exactly how to specify fonts, colors, glass effects, layouts, and motion in a way that makes AI produce work you're genuinely proud of. Let's begin.

Fonts: name them. Both of them.

The single fastest way to elevate any AI design.

Every AI tool has a default. And that default is almost always Inter or Roboto — clean, neutral, completely unremarkable. When you say "use a nice font," you're handing the wheel to the algorithm, and the algorithm plays it safe.

The fix is embarrassingly simple: name the fonts yourself. Not "a serif headline font." Not "something elegant." The actual name. The actual weights. The actual Google Fonts URL.

WHY TWO FONTS?

One font does one thing. A combination of two — a distinctive heading face and a refined body face — creates hierarchy, personality, and contrast. It's the difference between a page that feels designed and a page that feels generated.

THE FORMULA THAT WORKS

Pair an expressive, characterful headline font with a clean, legible body font. Italic display + light grotesque creates a luxury editorial feel.

HEADING	BODY	VIBE
Instrument Serif <i>(italic)</i>	Barlow 300 / 400	Luxury editorial
Anton	System mono	Industrial, Web3
Almarai 800	Almarai 300	Warm, cinematic

Stop saying "dark background."

Exact values, not vibes. A system, not a color.

Every beginner prompt says "dark background." The AI hears this and gives you #1a1a1a or #222222. That's dark grey. And dark grey is not cinematic. True black — #000000 or very close — is what separates cheap from premium.

But color isn't just the background. It's the entire opacity system that creates depth.

THE OPACITY HIERARCHY

On a dark, premium page you rarely use flat white text. You build a layered system at different opacities. The eye knows exactly where to look.

100%	Primary heading	HEADINGS · CTAS
70%	Subheading text	SUBHEADS
60%	Secondary body copy	BODY · DESCRIPTIONS
20%	Borders, dividers	UI · RULES

HOW TO SPECIFY COLOR

Use CSS custom properties in HSL. Define every value, including the opacity hierarchy. Give the AI a system, not a color — it produces consistent results across every component.

03/05

LAYER 03 OF 05

GLASS EFFECTS

Bad glass, and liquid glass.

Described physics, not buzzwords. Real glass catches light at the edges.

Glassmorphism is everywhere in 2026 — which means most of it looks the same. A blurry box with a white border. That's not liquid glass. That's a CSS tutorial.

Liquid glass catches light. It has gradient borders that fade in the middle, simulating real refraction. It has different strengths for different contexts. It behaves like a material.

TWO VERSIONS YOU ALWAYS NEED

SUBTLE · CARDS, NAVBAR, BADGES

backdrop-filter: blur(4px). Gradient border (no solid edge). Catches light at the edges.

STRONG · CTA BUTTONS, PROMINENT UI

backdrop-filter: blur(50px). Brighter gradient border. Box-shadow for depth. Weighty, premium.

SUBTLE

Glass card

STRONG

CTA button

04/05

LAYER 04 OF 05 · PART I

LAYOUT · SKELETON

Layout: give it a skeleton.

Don't say "clean layout." Name every section. Describe its structure.

This is where most intermediate prompt writers fail. They nail the fonts, colors, and glass — and then write "clean modern layout with hero, features, footer." The AI does its best, and its best is generic. Layout is architecture. You wouldn't hand an architect a brief that says "nice building." You'd hand them a floor plan. Section by section. Element by element.

01

SECTION · NAVBAR

Floating glass pill

Fixed, floating above content. Logo left. Nav links inside a glass pill, centered. Solid white CTA as the last item in the pill, with an ArrowUpRight icon. The pill shape alone signals "premium."

02

SECTION · HERO

Cinematic first impression

1000px tall. Video or image background. Badge pill above headline · animated headline · subtext with delay · two CTAs (one glass, one text-only) · partners bar at bottom: "Trusted by Stripe, Vercel, Linear."

03

SECTION · FEATURES

The chess layout

Alternate sides instead of card grids. Text left → media right · then flip · text right → media left. Each row carries a title, body paragraph, "Learn more" glass button, and media in a glass container. Visual rhythm replaces

04/05

LAYER 04 OF 05 · PART II

LAYOUT · FINISHING

The closing moves of the page.

04

SECTION · STATS

Desaturated video moment

Video background with `filter: saturate(0)`. A glass card on top with a 4-column grid of large stats. Strip color to make numbers pop — borrowed from cinema.

05

SECTION · TESTIMONIALS

Trust layer

Three-column grid. Glass cards. Quote in italic, lighter weight. Name and role below. Needs precision in card structure, not creativity in layout.

06

SECTION · CTA + FOOTER

The close

Full-width video background. Large italic headline. Two buttons: one glass, one solid white. The contrast is intentional — glass for primary, solid for secondary. Solid white reads louder, anchoring the eye against the moving video behind it.

The more sections you blueprint, the less the AI has to guess. Every guess it makes is a risk of getting it wrong.

05/05

LAYER 05 OF 05

MOTION · TIMING

Motion: timing like a creative director.

"Add animations" gets you bouncing buttons. This gets you a page that breathes.

Most beginners either skip motion or write "add smooth animations." Both produce something that moves but doesn't feel intentional. The difference between a page that loads and a page that *arrives* is choreography — sequence, timing, and restraint.

THE MOTION LANGUAGE

01

Headlines · word-by-word blur

Each word from `blur(10px)·y:50·opacity:0.100ms stagger. IntersectionObserver-triggered.`

02

Subtext · delayed blur fade

Same fade as a unit. Delay 0.8s. Duration 0.6s.

03

CTA buttons · last to enter

Same blur-fade. Delay 1.1s. Headline → subtext → action.

04

Video · faded edges

200px gradient overlays top + bottom. Hero bottom uses 300px.

05

Stats video · desaturate

`filter: saturate(0)` — strips color so numbers pop.

Motion isn't decoration. It's sequence.

Your brief is your design.

How to assemble all five layers into a prompt that works like magic.

THE MINDSET SHIFT

Stop thinking of prompts as instructions. Start thinking of them as briefs. A brief is what a creative director hands to a designer before a project begins. It says: here are the fonts, here's the color system, here's how the glass effects work, here's the section-by-section structure, here's how everything moves.

The AI is your junior designer. Exceptionally fast. Technically skilled. Completely dependent on the brief.

THE ASSEMBLY ORDER

01

Fonts

Google Fonts URL · weights · Tailwind aliases.

02

Color

CSS custom properties · full opacity hierarchy.

03

Glass effects

Full CSS for both subtle and strong.

04

Layout

Section-by-section, element-by-element blueprint.

05

Motion

Named patterns with exact timing.

— AND ONE LAST THOUGHT

"That's not a prompt. That's a brief."

THE DESIGN XSTREAM 5-LAYER PROMPT FRAMEWORK

Pick one project. Apply one layer. Notice the difference. Add the next. By the time you're writing all five naturally, you won't be prompting AI anymore — you'll be directing it.

— THE DESIGN XSTREAM TEAM